

IT'S JONES VS MIOCIC TIME

The **highly anticipated fight** was initially set to headline UFC 295 nearly a year ago, but an injury sidelined Jones for the remainder of 2023.

Nigamanth P

nigamanth.p@thehindu.co.in

It is finally happening.

Current heavyweight champion Jon Jones (**below**) will make the first defence of his undisputed title against Stipe Miocic (**facing page, below**) at UFC 309 in New York on November 17.

The long-awaited fight was first scheduled to headline UFC 295 almost a year ago, but Jones suffered an injury that kept him out of action for the rest of 2023.

Jones made his switch from light heavyweight to heavyweight at UFC 285 against Ciryl Gane. He put on an

impressive show and earned a first-round win to become one of the few fighters to hold titles in multiple divisions.

On the other hand, the bout is Miocic's first since he lost the title in March 2021. The Ohio native holds the UFC record for most consecutive heavyweight title defences (three) and most finishes in UFC heavyweight title fights (four).

The 42-year-old will hope to become a three-time heavyweight champion when he enters the octagon later this month.

Meanwhile, the co-main event is set to be a five-round rematch between former lightweight champion Charles Oliveira and

